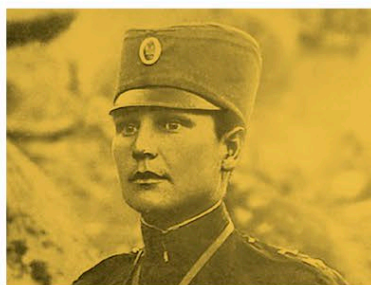




► Replacing the men

A French satirical cartoon published in *La Baionnette* in 1917 shows women in male jobs. Wives, sisters, and daughters began filling these salaried positions in France in 1915.



1892-1973

MILUNKA SAVIĆ

One of the most decorated female soldiers in history, Serbian Milunka Savić fought under her brother's name in the Balkan Wars (1912-1913), wearing men's clothes and cutting her hair. Because of her ability, she was allowed to fight in World War I even after her true identity was revealed, and in 1916 she single-handedly captured 23 Bulgarian soldiers. After the war, she returned to civilian life and worked as a cleaner before she was imprisoned in a Nazi concentration camp.



go home. Undeterred, she went to the French and Serbian governments, who allowed her to set up field hospitals. By the end of the war, her organization operated 14 medical units fully comprised of female volunteers. Similarly, in 1914, Mairi Chisholm and Elsie Knocker set up a dressing station, funded by donations, in some abandoned houses at the front line. The two women ventured into the trenches to retrieve the wounded, wearing nurses' veils so that the Germans would not target them, until they were seriously injured in a gas attack in 1918.

Thousands of women volunteered for auxiliary service, working as cooks, drivers, and secretaries. The US Army employed more than 200 "Hello Girls," who had to be fluent in French and English, to operate their telephone switchboards in France. Many of these auxiliary services were newly established during the war because manpower shortages created a desperate need for additional personnel.

Women were also employed in clandestine activity. The most famous spy of the conflict was Margaretha Geertruida MacLeod, a